TutorHub • Stripe Production Setup Guide

Step-by-Step Checklist to Go Live with Stripe Connect & Billing

PRODUCTION • LIVE MODE

> **Before You Begin:** Turn **OFF Test Mode** in the Stripe Dashboard using the toggle in the top-right corner. All actions below must be completed in **Live Mode**.

1 Activate Your Live Stripe Account & Platform Profile

To accept real money and onboard tutors on Stripe Connect, Stripe requires verified platform business credentials:

1. Log in to dashboard.stripe.com and toggle **Test Mode OFF**.
2. If prompted, complete **Account Activation**:
   - **Business Details:** Legal business name, business address, and Tax ID (EIN, VAT, GST, PAN, etc.).
   - **Bank Account:** Enter the bank account where platform revenue (Pro subscriptions) will be deposited.
   - **Representative:** Verify identity details (ID/Passport) of the primary account owner.
3. Go to **Settings** → **Connect** → **Platform profile** and configure:
   - **Branding:** Add your platform logo, icon, and brand colors (used in Stripe onboarding & emails).
   - **Support details:** Support email address and public website URL (`https://yourdomain.com`).

2 Enable Accounts v1 Support & Verify Connect Settings

TutorHub creates Express accounts programmatically using Stripe's API. Ensure policy compatibility:

1. Go to **Settings** → **Developers** → **API policies**:
   Direct link: `https://dashboard.stripe.com/settings/developers/api-policies/feat_accounts_v1_support`
2. Click the edit pencil next to **Accounts v1 support** and select **Enable**.
3. Go to **Settings** → **Connect**:
   - **Account types:** Ensure **Express** accounts are enabled.
   - **Business model:** Direct charges (buyers pay tutors directly).

3 Get Live API Keys

Generate your live environment credentials:

1. In the top search or navigation, go to **Developers** → **API keys** (in Live mode).
2. Copy the **Publishable key** (starts with `pk_live_...`).
3. Under **Standard keys** (or Secret keys), click **Create secret key**:
   - Name: `TutorHub Production Server`
   - Permissions: Select **Full access** (required for managing Connect accounts & subscriptions).
4. Copy the secret key immediately (starts with `sk_live_...`).

4 Create the Live "TutorHub Pro" Subscription & Customer Portal

Set up the live recurring subscription product for tutors:

1. Go to **Product catalogue** → **Add product**:
   - **Name:** `TutorHub Pro`
   - **Description:** `Unlimited bookings, custom domain, and priority listing`
   - **Pricing model:** Flat fee • **Recurring**
   - **Price:** Set your production monthly price (e.g., `€19.00 EUR` or `$19.00 USD`)
   - **Billing period:** Monthly
2. Click **Save product**.
3. Open the created product, go to the **Pricing** section, and copy the **Price ID** (starts with `price_...`).
4. **Activate the Customer Portal:**
   - Go to **Settings** → **Billing** → **Customer portal**.
   - Enable customers to: *Cancel subscriptions*, *Update payment methods*, and *View invoice history*.
   - Click **Save changes / Activate**.

5 Configure Live Webhook Endpoints

In production, Stripe sends HTTP POST requests directly to your live production domain:

1. Go to **Developers** → **Webhooks** → **Add endpoint**.
2. **Endpoint URL:** `https://your-domain.com/api/webhooks/stripe`
3. **Listen to:** Choose **Events on connected accounts** (or select *Both account and connected accounts*).

> **Critical:** TutorHub processes student → tutor bookings which occur on the tutor's Connected account. The webhook must receive Connected account events!

4. Click **Select events to listen to** and check the following 6 events:

Event Name	What TutorHub Does
`checkout.session.completed`	Confirms lesson bookings & packages, and activates the Pro subscription for tutors.
`checkout.session.expired`	Fails abandoned booking sessions so reserved calendar slots are freed.
`charge.refunded`	Marks lesson payments as refunded in the database.
`account.updated`	Detects when tutor completes Stripe onboarding and marks payouts enabled.
`customer.subscription.updated`	Maintains active/past-due state for tutor Pro subscriptions.
`customer.subscription.deleted`	Downgrades tutor back to the Free plan when their subscription cancels.

5. Click **Add endpoint**.
6. Under **Signing secret**, click **Reveal** and copy the secret (starts with `whsec_...`).

6 Production Environment Variables Reference

Add these environment variables to your production hosting provider (Vercel, Railway, Render, VPS):

```
# --- App Domain ---
NEXT_PUBLIC_APP_URL=https://your-domain.com

# --- Live Stripe Configuration ---
NEXT_PUBLIC_STRIPE_PUBLISHABLE_KEY=pk_live_your_actual_publishable_key
STRIPE_SECRET_KEY=sk_live_your_actual_secret_key
STRIPE_WEBHOOK_SECRET=whsec_your_actual_production_webhook_secret
STRIPE_PRO_PRICE_ID=price_your_actual_live_pro_price_id
```

7 Pre-Launch Verification Checklist

- [ ] **Tutor Onboarding:** Log in as a real tutor, click *Connect Stripe*, and verify completion of real Express onboarding.
- [ ] **Test Booking:** Create a test lesson with a real debit/credit card for $1.00 & verify booking confirmation.
- [ ] **Refund Test:** In Stripe Dashboard, issue a refund for the $1.00 test charge and verify status updates in TutorHub.
- [ ] **Webhook Monitoring:** Check **Developers** → **Webhooks** to confirm incoming requests return HTTP `200 OK`.